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Year 3 NAPLAN*-style Literacy Tests

Free-to-download Sample Tests with answers

Alan Horsfield &
Elaine Horsfield

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Sample Test 1

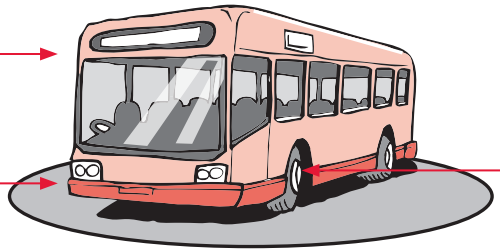
40 MIN

The spelling mistakes in these sentences have been highlighted.
Write the correct spelling for each highlighted word in the box.

1. Peter went ourside to see the stars. [ ]
2. "Who's been makeing a mess on the lawn?" asked Dad. [ ]
3. It was andother hot summer's day! [ ]
4. The fruit salad was full of bananas and berrys. [ ]
5. Our team was thankfull that they had finally reached the finals. [ ]
6. A page has been tawn from my atlas! [ ]
7. We watched the livesavers marching into the surf. [ ]
8. I have operned the door but the cat won't come in. [ ]
9. Tammy was bowling and Cindy was bating when the rain started. [ ]
10. Can you gess the correct answer? [ ]
11. We don't know whear Josie dropped her purse. [ ]

The spelling mistakes in these labels have been highlighted. Write the correct spelling for each highlighted word in the box.

12. moddern school bus [ ]
13. hedlight [ ]



14. front wheal [ ]

Each line has a word that is incorrect. Write the correct spelling of the word in the box.

15. After the bushwalk Olivia had nasty cuts on her bear arms. [ ]
16. The team had to wate until the last game to see who won the cup. [ ]
17. The hay shed was behinde the farmhouse, near the dry creek. [ ]
18. Full stops and question marks are easyly left out. [ ]

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Answers and explanations on pages 103–104

YEAR 3 LANGUAGE CONVENTIONS SAMPLE TEST 1

Read the text *The concert*. Each line has a word that is incorrect. Write the correct spelling in the box.

The concert

19 We were in our seats just befor the concert started. The first

20 song had a strong beet and soon had us clapping along in time

21 with the music. The lead singer allso played a guitar. But it was

22 the hairy drumer that I liked the best. He could play those drums!

The words below are pairs of opposites.
In each pair one word is spelled incorrectly. Write the correct spelling of the word in the box.

23 men womin

24 nite day

25 north sorth

26 Which word correctly completes the sentence?

The ruler was _____ from my school bag.

A took **B** taken **C** taked **D** tooken

27 Which word cannot be used as a plural?

A glass **B** teeth **C** fish **D** sheep

28 Which sentence has correct punctuation?

A When I think about war I get sad?
B When you leave, close the door?
C When Dad comes home I want you out of the bathroom?
D When will you finish your writing?

29 Which word correctly completes the sentence?

Aaron likes to listen to music _____ he has finished doing his homework.

A only **B** during **C** once **D** while

30 Which word can be used instead of the highlighted words?
Peter saw Greg, Ronny and Justin at the far end of the beach.
He decided to join Greg, Ronny and Justin because they were looking for crabs.

A them **B** it **C** they **D** him

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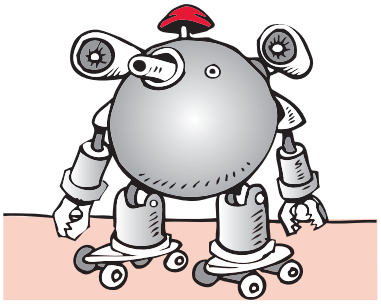
Answers and explanations on pages 103–104

YEAR 3 LANGUAGE CONVENTIONS SAMPLE TEST 1

Read the text *Robots*. The text has some gaps.
Choose the best option to fill each gap.



Robots

Some people can't wait to get a robot.

They are hoping _____ will do their	robots	robot's	Robot's	robots'
31	A	B	C	D
work for them. I _____ think this	dont	do'nt	do'not	don't
32	A	B	C	D
will happen. _____ they do all of	firstly, if	firstly if	Firstly, if	Firstly if,
33	A	B	C	D
the work no one will get _____ This	paid	paid.	Paid	paid,
34	A	B	C	D
could be the _____ idea ever!	most silly	sillier	silliest	silly
35	A	B	C	D

36 Which word correctly completes the sentence?
When Susie made a salad for lunch she added slices of an _____.

A cucumber
B beetroot
C tomato
D onion

37 Which word correctly completes the sentence?
After walking through the stream, Denis had _____ gravel in his joggers.

A a
B some
C an
D the

38 Which sentence has the correct punctuation?

A Cricket is a popular game in Australia.
B cricket is a popular game in Australia.
C Cricket is a popular game in Australia
D cricket is a popular game in australia?

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Answers and explanations on pages 103–104

YEAR 3 LANGUAGE CONVENTIONS SAMPLE TEST 1

Read the text *Lost girl*. The text has some gaps. Choose the correct word to fill each gap.

Lost girl

I was in the supermarket when I **39** a child crying. She was standing **40** the ice-cream counter. I thought she was lost. "Where's your Daddy?" I asked **41**.
"He's at the checkout **42** didn't buy me an ice cream!" she cried.

39 **A** heard **B** hearing **C** heared **D** hears

40 **A** close **B** over **C** near **D** in

41 **A** softer **B** softly **C** soft **D** softerly

42 **A** and **B** if **C** because **D** yet

43 Circle the letter to show where the missing comma (,) should go.

I really wanted to do well in the spelling reading and writing tests this year.

A B C D

44 Which of the following correctly completes the sentence?

Why we missed the bus I will never really know

A question mark (?) **B** comma (,) **C** exclamation mark (!) **D** full stop (.)

45 Which sentence has the correct punctuation?

A "Good morning," said Ms Johns as she entered our room.
B "Good morning, said Ms Johns," as she entered our room.
C "Good morning, said Ms Johns as she entered our room."
D Good morning, said Ms Johns as she entered our room.

Read the text *Fishing*. The text has some gaps. Choose the correct word to fill each gap.

Fishing

One day Dad said we should **46** fishing. I thought that was an **47** idea. I said I could get some worms from **48** small garden. Dad had a **49** idea. He had a packet of frozen bait in the freezer.

46 **A** go **B** going **C** gone **D** goes

47 **A** grand **B** fine **C** interesting **D** good

48 **A** myself **B** me **C** mine **D** my

49 **A** more better **B** better **C** more good **D** gooder

50 Which option correctly completes the sentence?

My _____ car was left in front of our gate.

A uncle's **B** uncles' **C** uncles **D** Uncle's

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Answers and explanations on pages 103–104

Sample Test Answers

LANGUAGE CONVENTIONS Sample Test 1

Pages 48–51

1 outside (Basic level) **2 making** (Intermediate level) **3 another** (Intermediate level) **4 berries** (Intermediate level) **5 thankful** (Advanced level) **6 torn** (Intermediate level) **7 lifesavers** (Intermediate level) **8 opened** (Basic level) **9 batting** (Intermediate level) **10 guess** (Intermediate level) **11 where** (Intermediate level) **12 modern** (Advanced level) **13 headlight** (Basic level) **14 wheel** (Basic level) **15 bare** (Intermediate level) **16 wait** (Basic level) **17 behind** (Basic level) **18 easily** (Intermediate level) **19 before** (Basic level) **20 beat** (Intermediate level) **21 also** (Basic level) **22 drummer** (Intermediate level) **23 women** (Basic level) **24 night** (Basic level) **25 south** (Intermediate level) **26 B** (Basic level) **27 A** (Intermediate level) **28 D** (Advanced level) **29 C** (Advanced level) **30 A** (Intermediate level) **31 A** (Basic level) **32 D** (Basic level) **33 C** (Advanced level) **34 B** (Intermediate level) **35 C** (Advanced level) **36 D** (Intermediate level) **37 B** (Basic level) **38 A** (Basic level) **39 A** (Basic level) **40 C** (Intermediate level) **41 B** (Advanced level) **42 A** (Basic level) **43 B** (Advanced level) **44 D** (Intermediate level) **45 A** (Intermediate level) **46 A** (Basic level) **47 C** (Intermediate level) **48 D** (Intermediate level) **49 B** (Basic level) **50 A** (Advanced level)

1 Make sure you pronounce the word correctly. Remember: *outside* is a compound word: *out* + *side*.

2 When adding ***ing*** to words that end with a consonant and ***e***, you should drop the ***e*** then add ***ing***.

3 Make sure you pronounce the word correctly. Remember: *another* is a compound word: *an* + *other*.

4 You can have one *berry* but many *berries*. When making plurals that end with a consonant and ***y***, you should change the ***y*** to ***i*** before adding ***es***. Examples are *pony*/*ponies*, *fairy*/*fairies*, *daisy*/*daisies*.

5 When adding the suffix ***ful*** to a word it is spelled with a single ***l***. Examples are *useful*, *wasteful*, *hopeful*.

6 The letters ***or*** and ***aw*** can make the same sound. Learn to recognise groups of words that fit into each group. Examples are *born, corn, horn* and *fawn, lawn, yawn*.

7 Make sure you pronounce the word correctly. Remember: *lifesavers* is a compound word: *life* + *savers*.

8 Make sure you pronounce the word correctly. *Open*ed is a two-syllable word: *o* + *pened*. It is the past tense of *open*, so it has the suffix ***ed***.

9 *Bat* is a short word ending in a vowel, then a consonant. For most short words that end this way you should double the final consonant before adding ***ing***. Examples are *run*/*running*, *tag*/*tagging*.

10 *Guess* is a word that doesn't fit readily into a word group. *Guess* is a common word you must learn and remember how to spell.

11 *Where* has a silent ***h***. A silent ***h*** after a ***w*** is a common letter combination (e.g. *what*, *when*). *Where* and *wear* are homonyms—words that sound the same but which are spelled differently. You *wear* clothes.

12 There is no double ***d*** in *modern*. *Modern* is a fairly common word you must learn and remember how to spell.

13 The letter combinations ***ed*** and ***ead*** can make the same sound. 'Hed' is not a word. ***Ed*** and ***ead*** can make the same sound in different words. Sometimes they are homonyms (e.g. *led* and *lead*)—words that sound the same but which are spelled differently. Learn to recognise and spell both groups of words. Remember: the ***ed*** group of words is more common than the ***ead*** group.

14 *Wheel* has a silent ***h***. A silent ***h*** after a ***w*** is a common letter combination (e.g. *wheat*, *why*). *Wheal* is an uncommon word to do with an injury. Think of the rhyming words *wheel* and *heel*.

15 *Bare* and *bear* are homonyms—words that sound the same but which are spelled differently. *Bare* refers to being uncovered. A *bear* is a rather large furry animal. The letter combinations ***are*** and ***ear*** can sometimes make the same sound.

16 'Wate' is not a word. The letter combinations ***ate*** and ***ait*** can sometimes make the same sound. ***Ate*** words are more common than ***ait*** words. Examples include *date*, *rate* and *hate*. *Bait* is an ***ait*** word.

17 *Behind* does not have an ***e*** ending. *Behind* is a common word you must learn and remember how to spell.

18 *Easily* is *easy* with the suffix ***ly***. When adding ***ly*** to words that end with the consonant ***y***, you change the ***y*** to an ***i*** and then add the ***ly***. Examples are *busy*/*busily*, *cosy*/*cosily*.

19 *Before* is a compound word: *be* + *fore*. There are several *fore*-sounding words (*for*, *four*). *Fore* is most often used to show being at the front.

20 *Beet* and *beat* are homonyms—words that sound the same but which are spelled differently. *Beet* refers to a purple vegetable. *Beat* has more to do with rhythm. Learn to recognise groups of words that fit into each group (e.g. *meet, feet, sheet* and *heat, seat, neat*).

21 *Also* is *al* + *so*. The word has the meaning of including something extra. *Also* only has a single ***l***. Get to know and spell the group of words with the ***al*** spelling (e.g. *always*, *already*).

22 *Drum* is a short word ending in a vowel, then a consonant. For most short words that end this way you should double the final consonant before adding ***er***. Examples are *drop*/*dropper*, *dim*/*dimmer*.

23 *Women* is a tricky word. The ***wo*** sounds like ***wi*** in women and ***woo*** in *woman*. *Women* is a word you must learn and remember how to spell.

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YEAR 3 LITERACY SAMPLE TEST ANSWERS

24 *Nite* is a common spelling for *night* in advertising. It is slang and not used in formal writing. The letters ***ight*** are a common letter combination. Learn to recognise words that fit into that group (e.g. *might, sight, fright*). Remember: there is no ***light*** on a dark ***night***.

25 The ***ou*** letter combination often has an ***ow*** sound as in *how*. *Mouth* is a rhyming word that has a similar spelling. *South* is a common word you must learn and remember how to spell.

26 *Take* is an irregular verb. Most verbs in English form their past tenses by adding ***ed*** (e.g. *he walked)*. There are a number of irregular verbs when this doesn't happen. So the past of *take* is *taken* instead of 'taked'. With *taken* you need a 'helper'—another verb to 'help' it. *Were and was* can be helping verbs (e.g. *he was taken*).

27 Many plural nouns end in ***s***. A final ***s*** does not necessarily mean the noun is a plural. The plural of *glass* is *glasses*. Note: sheep can be used both as a singular and plural noun.

28 *When* can be used to ask a question about time. *When* can also be used as a conjunction (joining word) or an adverb (helping a verb).

29 *Once* is used as a conjunction. It joins two parts of the sentence. *While* and *during* makes the tense of the sentence illogical.

30 *Them* is a pronoun used to refer to a group of things or people. It saves repeating a series of names.

31 *Robots* is a common noun. There is no need for a capital letter. There is no need for an apostrophe as the robots do not own anything.

32 *Don't* is a shortened word for *do not*. An apostrophe is used to indicate that letters have been left out.

33 Commas are used to show a pause in a sentence.

34 *Paid* is an irregular verb. Most verbs in English form their past tenses by adding ***ed*** (e.g. *he walked)*. There are a number of irregular verbs when this doesn't happen. So the past of *pay* is *paid* instead of 'payed'.

35 *Silliest* is an adjective. Adjectives can be used to compare. Adjectives end with ***est*** when comparing more than two things. Adjectives end with ***er*** when comparing only two things. Remember: *silly*, *sillier*, *silliest*.

36 The definite articles are *a* and *an*. They are used before nouns and adjectives. If the noun begins with a vowel sound, then *an* is used—*an onion*.

37 When talking about uncountable nouns, such as sand (or grass or air), *a* or *an* are not used. *The* is used to refer to a particular object. *Some* is used in this sentence because the exact amount of gravel is not known.

38 The sentence is a statement and must end with a full stop. It must start with a capital letter. *Australia* is a proper noun and also requires a capital letter.

39 *Hear* is an irregular verb. Most verbs in English form their past tenses by adding ***ed*** (e.g. *he walked)*. There are a number of irregular verbs when this doesn't happen. So the past of *hear* is *heard* instead of 'heared'.

40 *Near* is the correct preposition. Often prepositions go with certain nouns in certain situations. In this text, *close* would require a preposition: *close to*.

41 *Softly* is an adverb. It tells how some people speak. Many adverbs end in ***ly***. *Soft* is an adjective.

42 *And* is a conjunction that is used to connect a second idea which follows from the first idea in the sentence.

43 Commas are used in lists where there are more than two items. *And* is used between the last two items in a series or list.

44 Although the sentence begins with *why* it is not a question. The speaker is making a statement. The sentence must end with a full stop.

45 Only the actual words spoken are in inverted commas (or quotation marks). The spoken words are: "*Good morning,*".

46 *Gone* is the wrong tense. It is past tense. *Go* is present tense.

47 *An* is used before nouns or adjectives (describing words) that begin with a vowel sound.

48 Make sure you pronounce your words correctly. As the garden belongs to the speaker, the correct term is *my garden*.

49 Adjectives can be used to compare. *Good* is used to describe one person. *Better* is used to compare two people. *Best* is used when comparing three or more people. Remember: *good*, *better*, *best*. *More good* and *more better* are incorrect English.

50 To show ownership by one person you add an apostrophe + ***s***. *Uncle* is a common noun in this sentence and does not require a capital letter.

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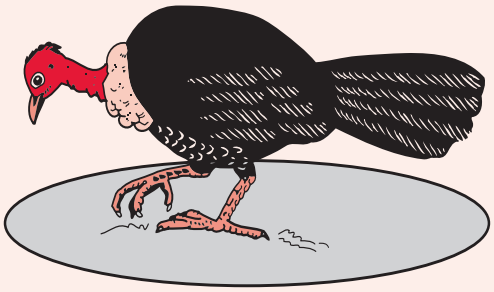
Sample Test 1

45 MIN

Read *The first birds* and answer questions 1 to 6. Circle the correct answers.

The first birds



The Aboriginal people of Australia, like many other races all over the world, believed that the Earth and all the living things on it were created by a god. In nearly all the stories told by the old people of the tribes, in different parts of Australia, the god's name was Baiami.

One story tells that after he had formed the land and several of the creatures on it, Baiami created birds from a rainbow. When the rainbow filled the sky like an upside-down bowl, Baiami shattered it into a thousand tiny pieces. Each piece became a bird and began falling to the earth.

It was a very beautiful sight and one animal that used to go on four legs, the kangaroo, stood on his hind legs and watched with great wonder. Because he watched for so long, the story says, he remained in that position and now his front legs are very tiny and not for standing on.

Most of the birds enjoyed the experience of falling to earth and sang joyfully. They gradually learned how to use their wings and nearly all of them were able to fly onto branches of trees in the forest before they reached the ground. They were all different sizes and colours and they continued to sing with happiness.

One bird which was not so contented was the Brush Turkey. He was too clumsy to fly with his stumpy wings and overgrown body. Also, he was ashamed of his plain black feathers. Brush Turkey now builds a big nest of leaf litter on the ground. Leaves are scratched into a big pile and the eggs hidden deep in the piled-up leaves and twigs.

1 According to the passage, which statement is correct?
- **A** The rainbow was once the other way up.
- **B** Brush Turkey is not as colourful as most other birds.
- **C** The kangaroo was hit with part of the broken rainbow.
- **D** It took many gods to make the birds and animals.

2 What is leaf litter?
- **A** old rubbish
- **B** bits of things that no one wants
- **C** a nest built by Brush Turkey
- **D** leaves and twigs on the ground

3 According to the story, the kangaroo's front legs are short because he
- **A** uses his back legs for hopping.
- **B** saw an upside down rainbow in the sky.
- **C** watched birds flying over the rainbow.
- **D** stood on his back legs for too long.

4 According to the passage, why do most birds have colourful feathers? Write your answer on the lines.

_____

_____

5 The Brush Turkey is described as clumsy. The word *clumsy* means almost the same as
- **A** large.
- **B** flightless.
- **C** awkward.
- **D** clever.

6 This story is an example of a
- **A** legend.
- **B** report.
- **C** factual recount.
- **D** description.

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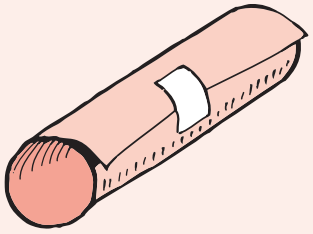
Answers and explanations on page 108

YEAR 3 READING SAMPLE TEST 1

Read the instructions for making *A fun X-ray tube* and answer questions 7 to 12. Circle the correct answers.

A fun x-ray tube



An X-ray tube is easy to make and fun to use.

You will need

a sheet of A4 paper

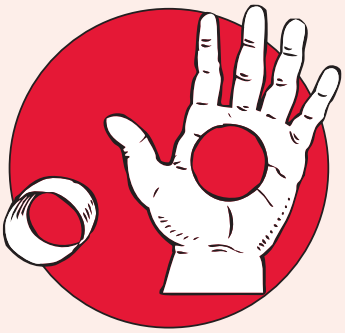
sticky tape (or craft glue)

Steps

Roll up the sheet of paper to make a cylinder—this is your tube.

Use the tape to stop your tube from unrolling.

You now have your X-ray tube!



Using your X-ray tube

Look through the tube with one eye as if you were looking through a telescope.

Hold up your other open hand beside the far end of the tube.

It has to be in front of your other eye. Keep that eye open too.

You will see a hole right through your hand.

If you don't see a hole, try moving your hand up and down the outside of the tube until you find a position that works.

Of course, if you have an old paper towel roll that will save you having to make the tube—and you will still have fun with your friend and your X-ray tube.

7 How many steps does it take to make an X-ray tube?
A one **B** two **C** three **D** four

8 According to the instructions, instead of making a cylinder out of paper you could
A make a circle with your finger and thumb.
B buy one at a shop.
C get an old piece of pipe.
D use a cylinder from a used roll of paper towels.

9 To see through your hand you need to
A close the right eye.
B close the left eye.
C have both eyes open.
D squint with both eyes.

10 These instructions could best be described as
A complicated. **B** time-consuming. **C** dangerous. **D** very simple.

11 The X-ray tube could best be described as
A an interesting device. **B** magic. **C** an experiment. **D** an eye test.

12 The main purpose of the X-ray tube is to
A teach children the skills in making a cylinder.
B have a fun object to play with.
C show how X-rays work.
D provide cheap scientific equipment.

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Answers and explanations on pages 108–109

YEAR 3 READING SAMPLE TEST 1

Read the poem *The twins* and answer questions 13 to 18. Circle the correct answers.

The twins

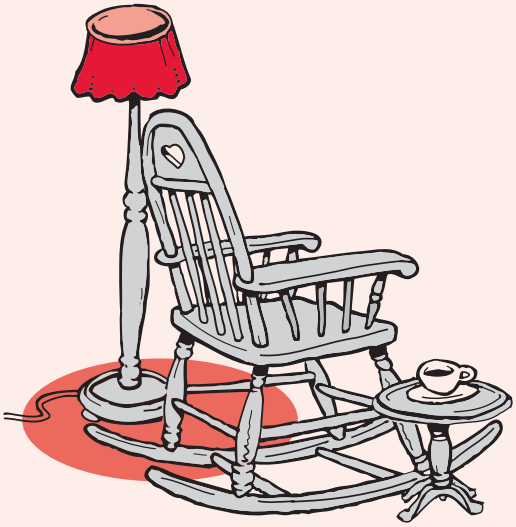
1 Macavity is a tiger cat;
2 A wild ferocious autocrat;
3 The bully of his habitat;
4 A furious, galloping acrobat.

5 But Bella's far more dignified.
6 She's elegance personified.
7 Her manners no one can deride,
8 She often seems preoccupied.

9 Macavity is a hurricane
10 The warring lord of his domain,
11 He dashes to a new campaign
12 While Bella looks on with disdain.

13 Macavity rushes on madcap
14 An animated rodent trap,
15 But Bella finds her owner's lap
16 And settles for a long catnap.

Elaine Horsfield



13 Macavity and Bella are
A house cats.
B rodents.
C soldiers.
D tigers.

14 Bella is described as *dignified* (line 5). This means she
A is hard to keep amused.
B spends a lot of time sitting quietly.
C is respectful and well behaved.
D requires a lot of love and attention.

15 Which word best describes Macavity?
A nasty
B energetic
C ill-tempered
D sulky

16 What does Macavity like to do?
A fight with Bella
B sit on his owner's lap
C keep people awake
D catch mice and rats

17 Bella would be a good pet for
A relaxed, calm people.
B anyone with a mouse problem.
C children who want to play with pets.
D a person who plays a lot of sport.

18 Which statement is correct?
A Bella and Macavity are the same age.
B Macavity performs in a circus.
C Bella and Macavity like doing the same things.
D It's hard to tell Bella and Macavity apart.

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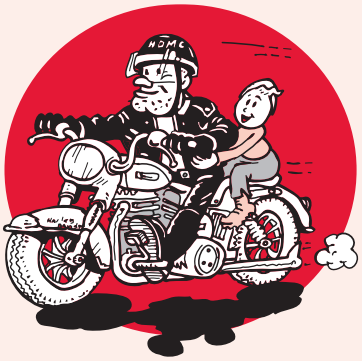
Answers and explanations on page 109

YEAR 3 READING SAMPLE TEST 1

Read the recount *Mark the bikie* and answer questions 19 to 24. Circle the correct answers.

Mark the bikie

Early last Sunday a man rode up into our driveway on a noisy black motorbike. He wore black leather pants, a black leather jacket and a helmet with HDMC above the eye protection shield. I'd never seen him before.



As I watched him from behind the screen door, he dismounted his bike and slowly took off his helmet. I stepped back from the screen door. I wanted to be out of sight.

Suddenly my father came running down the side driveway. He rushed towards the motorcyclist. I couldn't tell if he was angry or amazed.

The man in black lifted his arm and took a step towards Dad. I waited, as the cyclist and Dad stood facing each other for a long moment. Then the man in black leather and my dad gave each other a big hug.

They spent more than five minutes talking and laughing. I moved out onto the veranda but kept well back.

My dad looked around and saw me. 'Hey Sylvia, This is Mark. Mark and I went to school together. I haven't seen him for twenty years!' he called.

I went down the steps to meet Mark. He put out his hand with a big smile. I relaxed as we shook hands.

After a while Mark showed me his bike. It was a grand old Harley Davidson. Dad said I could go for a ride with Mark if I wore my bicycle helmet. I couldn't believe it. I'd never been on a motorbike before.

I could hardly describe how I felt but it was great skimming along just above the road surface. It was like low-level flying and I can't wait to do it again, especially on a Harley.

19 It is most likely Mark's visit was

A a shock. **B** unexpected. **C** overdue. **D** a regular event.

20 What did Sylvia's father first do after Mark got off his bike?

A shook Mark's hand **B** called to Sylvia
C gave Mark a big hug **D** ran down the drive

21 Write the numbers 1 to 4 in the boxes to show the correct order in which events happened in the text. The first one (1) has been done for you

	Sylvia's father ran down the driveway.
1	A motorbike came up the driveway to Sylvia's home.
	Sylvia had a ride on a Harley Davidson.
	Sylvia's dad and the bikie hugged each other.

22 What made the ride with Mark extra special for Sylvia?

A Her father suggested she should have a ride. **B** It was on a Harley Davidson.
C Mark was an old school friend of Sylvia's father. **D** Sylvia had been afraid of speed.

23 How did Sylvia feel when Mark rode up the driveway?

A impatient **B** excited **C** cautious **D** worried

24 Another good name for the story would be

A Hiding on the veranda. **B** Scary handshake.
C The Harley Davidson. **D** Sylvia's first motorbike ride.

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Answers and explanations on page 109

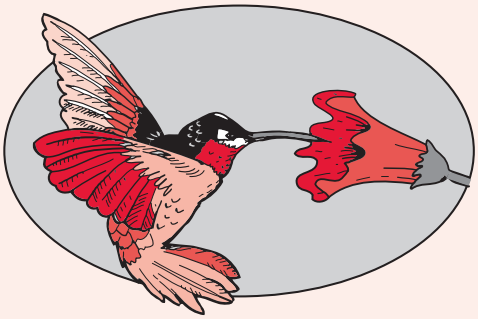
YEAR 3 READING SAMPLE TEST 1

Read the information report about *Hummingbirds* and answer questions 25 to 30. Circle the correct answers.

Hummingbirds

Hummingbirds are very small birds with long, thin, tapered bills. They weigh about 4 grams and are about 8 centimetres from tip of bill to tip of tail. The smallest bird in the world is the Bee Hummingbird. It weighs 1.8 grams and grows to about 5 centimetres long. This line is about 5 centimetres long.

The hummingbird's bill has a long, grooved tongue. It can feed on nectar deep within flowers. They feed about every ten minutes all day, and they may eat more than half of their body weight daily. Their main diet is sugar, which comes from nectar in flowers or tree sap. They also eat insects and pollen for protein to build muscles. They become pollinators as they feed, moving from flower to flower.



Hummingbirds can fly right, left, up, down, backwards, even upside down. They can hover. Most birds get their power to fly from the downstroke only. Hummingbirds have power on the upstroke, as well. When hovering, hummingbirds hold their bodies upright and flap their wings horizontally in a figure eight motion.

Most hummingbirds flap their wings about 50 times a second and their wings become a blur. They have a fast breathing rate, a fast heartbeat, and a high body temperature.

Their tiny feet are mainly for perching. If they want to travel just a few centimetres, they fly. Hummingbirds rise from perches without pushing off. They rise by flapping their wings at almost full speed before lift-off. Though they fly very fast, they can suddenly stop and make a soft landing.

Male and female hummingbirds have separate territories. The female's territory is for nest building and for feeding her chicks. The male territory is to protect a reliable food source. The male does not help with nest building or feeding the chicks.

25 What makes the Bee Hummingbird different from other hummingbirds?
A It can fly upside down.
B The male and female both build nests.
C It cannot walk.
D It is the smallest of all hummingbirds.

26 Why does the hummingbird have a long bill?
A to defend its territory
B to get nectar out of deep flowers
C to help pollinate flowers
D to provide balance when it flies

27 What is the reason for the black line under the first paragraph?
A The line separates the first paragraph from the second paragraph.
B The line points to a picture of a hummingbird.
C It shows just how small a Bee Hummingbird is without getting out a ruler.
D It's the same length as the hummingbird's bill.

28 A hummingbird's wings can look like a blur because they
A are very small.
B are the same colour as the bird itself.
C move in many directions.
D flap very quickly while hovering.

29 Hummingbirds need plenty of muscle power. What food helps to build their muscle power?
A nectar **B** insects **C** sap **D** petals

30 What is the most likely reason hummingbirds feed about every ten minutes?
Write your answer on the lines.

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Answers and explanations on page 110

YEAR 3 READING SAMPLE TEST 1

Look at the cartoon picture of Reece's bedroom and answer questions 31 to 35. Circle the correct answers.

31 Reece is mainly interested in
A homework. **B** sport. **C** minding pets. **D** reading.

32 The behaviour of the cat suggests that it is
A looking for a place to sleep.
B wanting to be picked up.
C hiding from something scary.
D waiting to be fed.

33 In which room is the cartoon set?
A Reece's bedroom
B a home office
C a gym dressing room
D Jason's bedroom

34 The cartoon is amusing because
A Reece is making up weak excuses for not having a tidy room.
B monsters and vampires prefer to hide under beds.
C the cat thinks it is hiding from Reece and Jason.
D Jason is worried that he will have to clean up the mess.

35 The exclamation marks in Jason's speech bubble suggest he is
A frightened. **B** excited. **C** panicky. **D** confused.

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Answers and explanations on page 110

YEAR 3 READING SAMPLE TEST 1

Read the story *The things people say* and answer questions 36 to 40. Circle the correct answers.

The things people say

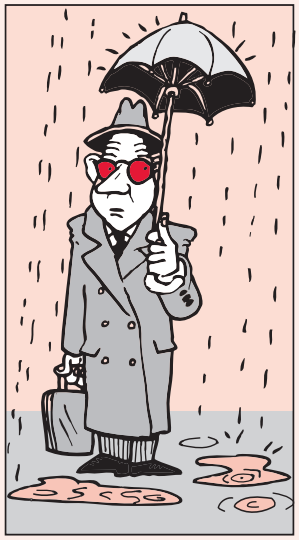
Adults say the weirdest things.

My teacher once told Harley he had two left feet! Poor Harley. I looked under the desks. I expected to see two feet on Harley's left leg! Harley's legs were just like all the other legs. The things people say.

What do adults really mean when they ask, 'Do you have a frog in your throat?' Yuk! I could think of nothing worse than a live frog in my throat—well, maybe a dead one!

Once, when I felt cross Dad asked if my nose was out of joint. It wasn't broken? That silly question upset me even more than I was!

One Sunday, while I was sitting at my desk, colouring, heavy rain started to fall. I heard Dad come into the laundry from the farmyard.



Mum called, 'That you Ed? It's raining cats and dogs out there!'

I looked towards the misted window. Raining cats and dogs? Now that's odd.

'Coming down in buckets!' Dad replied.

I hurried to the window, afraid I might see buckets of cats and dogs falling out of the sky.

All I saw was heavy rain. I shook my head and returned to my desk.

The things people say! They do it all the time!

From the laundry I heard Dad say, 'Hardly room to swing a cat in here.'

I had this horrible thought! Dad was going to grab our cat by its front legs and swing it around the laundry in some sort of crazy dance.

As I rushed to the kitchen Mum laughed, 'Ed, we have cats on the brain today!'

I stopped, looked at them and frowned.

Dad asked, 'Hey Meg, what's up?'

I replied, 'I think … the cat's got my tongue.' They gave me an odd look.

As I turned away I said, 'Just pulling your leg.' Then I walked off, leaving my parents scratching their heads. I can say some strange things too.

36 The text is an example of
A an explanation. **B** a myth. **C** a narrative. **D** a report.

37 What did the teacher mean when she said Harley had two left feet?
A Harley was clumsy on his feet. **B** Harley had his shoes on the wrong feet.
C Harley had his legs crossed. **D** Harley really had three legs.

38 If someone says the rain is coming down in buckets they mean
A the rain is falling in just one spot. **B** the rain won't last long.
C it is raining so much it hurts. **D** it is raining really heavily.

39 What was Dad doing when it started to rain?
A He was busy working on his farm. **B** He was looking for the cats and dogs.
C He was working in the laundry. **D** He was rushing around the kitchen.

40 When Meg said, 'Just pulling your leg,' she was
A making a joke. **B** getting annoyed. **C** talking nonsense. **D** feeling confused.

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Answers and explanations on pages 110–111

YEAR 3 LITERACY SAMPLE TEST ANSWERS

READING Sample Test 1

The first birds

Page 60

1 **B** (Intermediate level) **2** **D** (Advanced level) **3** **D** (Basic level) **4** **Most birds were created from pieces of broken rainbow.** (Basic level) **5** **C** (Advanced level) **6** **A** (Advanced level)

1 This is an **inferring type of question**. To find the answer you have to 'read between the lines'. You read the *[Brush Turkey] was ashamed of his plain, black feathers (see line 18)*. You also read that the other birds *were all different sizes and colours (see line 16)*. So now you know the Brush Turkey is not as colourful as other birds. It has plain black feathers. The other birds were the colours of a rainbow. You can also rule out the other options to help you make your choice. You read *the rainbow filled the sky like an upside-down bowl (see line 8)* so the rainbow was always the same way up. You also read *all the living things on it [Earth] were created by a god (see lines 2–3)*, so only one (*a*) god made the birds and animals. Nowhere can you read that the kangaroo was hit by part of the rainbow.

2 This is an **inferring type of question**. To find the answer you have to 'read between the lines'. You read *leaf litter [is] on the ground (see line 19)*. You also read *Leaves are scratched into a big pile and the eggs hidden deep in the piled-up leaves and twigs (see lines 19–20)*. Combine this with your own knowledge to work out the final answer. Leaf litter is leaves and twigs lying on the ground.

3 This is a **fact-finding type of question**. The answer is a fact in the text. You read *Because he [the kangaroo] watched for so long, the story says, he remained in that position and now his front legs are very tiny and not for standing on (see lines 12–13)*.

4 This is a **fact-finding type of question**. The answer is a fact in the text. You read *Baiami created birds from a rainbow (see line 7)*. You also read *They were all different sizes and colours (see line 16)*.

5 This is a **language type of question**. To find the answer you have to read the text carefully, especially the section that is quoted. You read that the Brush Turkey *was too clumsy to fly with his stumpy wings and overgrown body (see lines 17–18)*. The word *clumsy* means almost the same as *awkward*. A clumsy animal is one that is poorly coordinated. The Brush Turkey could not fly because of his odd shape and size.

6 This is a **synthesis type of question**. To find the answer you have to read the whole text. You read *The Aboriginal people of Australia, like many other races all over the world, believed that the Earth and all the living things on it were created by a god (see lines 1–3)*. You also read *One story tells that after he had formed the land and several of the creatures on it, Baiami created birds from a rainbow (see lines 6–7)*. So you know that this is only *one* story to explain the creation of earth. The rest of the text goes into further detail about this story. The text is an Aboriginal legend to explain the creation of earth. A legend is a story that has been passed down through time to explain something and is unlikely to be true.

A fun X-ray tube

Page 61

7 **B** (Basic level) **8** **D** (Basic level) **9** **C** (Intermediate level) **10** **D** (Intermediate level) **11** **A** (Intermediate level) **12** **B** (Advanced level)

7 This is a **fact-finding type of question**. The answer is a fact in the text. You read two steps: *Roll up the sheet of paper to make a cylinder—this is your tube* and *Use the tape to stop your tube from unrolling (see lines 6–7)*.

8 This is a **fact-finding type of question**. The answer is a fact in the text. You read *Of course, if you have an old paper towel roll that will save you having to make the tube (see line 17)*.

9 This is a **fact-finding type of question**. The answer is a fact in the text. You read *Look through the tube with one eye (see line 10)*. You also read *It has to be in front of your other eye. Keep that eye open too (see line 13)*.

10 This is a **judgement type of question**. You read *An X-ray tube is easy to make (see line 1)*. Combine this information with your own understanding of the text. These instructions could best be described as very simple. They are made out of easy-to-find materials. To make the X-ray tube does not take long and is not a dangerous activity.

11 This is a **judgement type of question**. You read *An X-ray tube is easy to make and fun to use (see line 1)*. The X-ray tube is an interesting device. It has no special or practical purpose.

12 This is a **judgement type of question**. You read *An X-ray tube is … fun to use (see line 1)* and *still have fun with your friend and your X-ray tube (see line 18)*. Although you may learn how to make a cylinder, the *main* purpose of the X-ray tube is to be a fun object to play with and share with friends. The tube does not really show you how X-rays work or provide you with scientific equipment.

The twins

Page 62

13 **A** (Basic level) **14** **C** (Intermediate level) **15** **B** (Advanced level) **16** **D** (Advanced level) **17** **A** (Advanced level) **18** **A** (Intermediate level)

13 This is an **inferring type of question**. To find the answer you have to 'read between the lines'. You read *Macavity … [is] an animated rodent trap (see lines 13–14)*. You also read *But Bella finds her owner's lap/ And settles for a long catnap (see lines 15–16)*. Combine

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this information with your own knowledge to work out the final answer. Macavity and Bella are house cats. The clues are in the things they do. They trap rodents (rats and mice) and sleep on laps.

14 This is a **language type of question**. To find the answer you have to read the text carefully, especially the section that is quoted: *Bella's far more dignified (see line 5)*. *Dignified* means 'noble, honourable, respectful'. You read Bella is *elegance personified (see line 6)* and *Her manners no one can deride (see line 7)*. If Bella is *elegant* she behaves in a refined way. She doesn't rush about madly. So Bella is respectful and well behaved.

15 This is an **inferring type of question**. To find the answer you have to 'read between the lines'. You read *Macavity is a hurricane (see line 9)* and a *galloping acrobat (see line 4)* who *dashes (see line 11)* and *rushes (see line 13)* around. All these words imply a lot of movement which means that Macavity must be energetic.

16 This is a **fact-finding type of question**. The answer is a fact in the text. You read that Macavity is an *animated rodent trap (see line 14)*. Mice and rats are rodents so if Macavity is a rodent trap it means he catches mice and rats.

17 This is a **judgement type of question**. You read that Bella is *dignified (see line 5)* and *But Bella finds her owner's lap/And settles for a long catnap (see lines 15–16)*. As Bella doesn't like rushing around, but prefers to catnap, she would be a good pet for relaxed, calm people. Children or sports people would need a more active cat like Macavity. Also, Macavity is the mouse and rat catcher, not Bella.

18 This is an **inferring type of question**. To find the answer you have to 'read between the lines'. You read the title of the poem: *The twins*. So if Bella and Macavity are twins, they must be the same age.

Mark the bikie

Page 63

19 **B** (Advanced level) **20** **D** (Intermediate level) **21** **2, 1, 4, 3** (Advanced level) **22** **B** (Advanced level) **23** **C** (Intermediate level) **24** **D** (Advanced level)

19 This is an **inferring type of question**. To find the answer you have to 'read between the lines'. You read that Sylvia *wanted to be out of sight (see line 6)* on the veranda. She had *never seen him [the bikie] before (see lines 2–3)*. You also read *Mark and I [Sylvia's father] went to school together. I haven't seen him for twenty years! (lines 14–15)*. Combine this information with your own knowledge to work out that the visit was unexpected and not a regular event. Sylvia's father rushed down the drive to greet the visitor. The two men stood and looked at each other for a moment before hugging. It was not a shock because a *shock* implies an unpleasant surprise. Sylvia's father was *laughing (see line 12)* and Mark had a *big smile (see line 16)* so it was a pleasantly unexpected meeting.

20 This is a **fact-finding type of question**. The answer is a fact in the text. You read *Mark dismounted his bike (see line 4)* and then you read *Suddenly my father came running down the side driveway (see line 7)*. It was only later they hugged and her father called to Sylvia. They never shook hands.

21 This is a **sequencing fact-finding type of question**. You can find the answer because it's a fact in the text. By reading the text carefully you can identify the correct order of events: 1) A motorbike came up the driveway to Sylvia's home. 2) Sylvia's father ran down the driveway. 3) Sylvia's dad and the bikie hugged each other. 4) Sylvia had a ride on a Harley Davidson.

22 This is an **inferring type of question**. To find the answer you have to 'read between the lines'. You read the ride was on the *grand, old Harley Davidson (see line 17)*. You also read *I can't wait to do it again, especially on a Harley (see line 20)*. The word *especially* is the clue to why the ride is extra special.

23 This is a **judgement type of question**. You are told how Sylvia behaved when Mark arrived. You read *I'd never seen him [Mark] before (see lines 2–3)*. You also read *I watched him from behind the screen door (see line 4)* and *I wanted to be out of sight (see line 6)*. Combine this information with your own knowledge. *Cautious* means 'careful in the presence of someone or something unknown'. Sylvia was cautious. She didn't know who the person was and what to expect. He looked a bit threatening.

24 This is a **synthesis type of question**. To find the answer you have to read the whole text. The most important event in the text is Sylvia getting to ride on Mark's motorbike. Another good title for the story would be: *Sylvia's first motorbike ride*. The other options in the question focus on less important detail or events.

Hummingbirds

Page 64

25 **D** (Basic level) **26** **B** (Intermediate level) **27** **C** (Intermediate level) **28** **D** (Intermediate level) **29** **B** (Basic level) **30** **Hummingbirds use a lot of energy when hovering. They feed on the nectar in flowers. The nectar (sugar) gives them energy.** (Advanced level)

25 This is a **fact-finding type of question**. The answer is a fact in the text. You read *The smallest bird in the world is the Bee Hummingbird (see line 2)*.

26 This is a **fact-finding type of question**. The answer is a fact in the text. You read *The hummingbird's bill has a long, grooved tongue. It can feed on nectar deep within flowers (see line 4)*.

27 This is an **inferring type of question**. To find the answer you have to 'read between the lines'. You read the Bee Hummingbird *grows to about 5 centimetres*

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long (see line 3). You next read *This line is about 5 centimetres long (see line 3)*. Having the line next to the description of the hummingbird makes it easy for readers to know how long the bird is. There is no reason to get a ruler to know the size of the bird.

28 This is a **fact-finding type of question**. The answer is a fact in the text. You read *Most hummingbirds flap their wings about 50 times a second and their wings become a blur (see lines 15–16)*. Fifty times a second is very fast.

29 This is a **fact-finding type of question**. The answer is a fact in the text. You read *They also eat insects and pollen for protein to build muscles (see lines 6–7)*.

30 This is a **judgement type of question**. You read *Most hummingbirds flap their wings about 50 times a second and their wings become a blur (see lines 15–16)*. Fifty times a second is very fast. Combine this information with your own knowledge to work out that because they use a lot of energy while flying they would need to feed often. The food gives them energy.

Cartoon

Page 65

31 **B** (Intermediate level) **32** **C** (Intermediate level) **33** **A** (Basic level) **34** **A** (Advanced level) **35** **D** (Advanced level)

31 This is an **inferring type of question**. To find the answer you have to 'read between the lines'. You see in the cartoon that Reece's cupboard is overflowing with sports equipment and there is sports gear on the floor. He is mainly interested in sport.

32 This is a **judgement type of question**. You can see the look on the cat's face with its wide-open eyes which suggests that it is hiding from something scary or even something that is quite strange.

33 This is a **fact-finding type of question**. The answer is a fact in the text. You can see the bed in the room and Reece is explaining to Jason why there is so much mess. It is Reece's bedroom.

34 This is a **judgement type of question**. You read *If it's full of mess then there's no room for monsters, murderers and vampires (see lines 1–4)*. The cartoon is amusing because Reece is making weak excuses for having a messy room. You can also help decide on the final answer by ruling out the other options. Cats don't think and there is no indication Jason is worried. Monsters and vampires are fictional creatures.

35 This is a **language type of question**. To find the answer you have to read the text carefully, especially the section that is quoted: ***!!!***. Exclamation marks are usually used after an exclamation sentence to express emotions such as surprise, disbelief or dismay. By looking at the expression on Jason's face you can see that here the exclamation marks express confusion. Jason does not look frightened, excited or panicky. He looks confused. Reece's reason for the messy room doesn't make sense to Jason.

The things people say

Page 66

36 **C** (Advanced level) **37** **A** (Advanced level) **38** **D** (Advanced level) **39** **A** (Basic level) **40** **A** (Advanced level)

36 This is a **synthesis type of question**. To find the answer you have to read the whole text. The text is about the funny things that Meg hears people say. You read *Adults say the weirdest things (see line 1)*. You also read *Then I walked off, leaving my parents scratching their heads. I can say some strange things too! (see lines 24–25)*. The text is an example of a narrative or a story. It is intended to amuse and the events happen, more or less, in chronological order.

37 This is a **language type of question**. To find the answer you have to read the text carefully, especially the section that is quoted: *My teacher once told Harley he had two left feet! (see line 2)*. You also read *Harley's legs were just like all the other legs (see line 3)*. The phrase *two left feet* is an expression used to describe someone who is clumsy, especially on their feet. It is an example of figurative language where the reader shouldn't take the meaning literally.

38 This is a **language type of question**. To find the answer you have to read the text carefully, especially the section that is quoted: *Coming down in buckets (see line 12)*. You also read *All I saw was heavy rain (see line 15)*. If the rain is *Raining cats and dogs* and *Coming down in buckets* then it is raining very heavily, so heavily it could have been poured straight out from a bucket. The sentence is an exaggeration people use to describe something in an amusing way. It is an example of figurative language where the reader shouldn't take the meaning literally.

39 This is a **fact-finding type of question**. The answer is a fact in the text. You read *I heard Dad come into the laundry from the farmyard (see line 9)*.

40 This is a **language type of question**. To find the answer you have to read the text carefully, especially the section that is quoted: *Just pulling your leg*. The sentence is an expression people use to explain to someone that they have been joking. Meg was making a joke. What she said was just another expression, a bit like the kind of things her parents had been saying. It is an example of figurative language where the reader shouldn't take the meaning literally.

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Year 3 Writing

Sample Test 1

40 MIN

Before you start, make sure you read the Tips for Writing on page 43.

Today you are going to write a persuasive text, often called an exposition.

Pupil-free school days

Many schools have pupil-free days. These are days, usually the day after a school holiday, when teachers go to school but students do not.

What do you think of pupil-free days?
Write to convince a reader of your opinions.

Before you start writing, give some thought to:

- whether you strongly agree or disagree with having pupil-free days
- the way you will present your ideas: clearly list or order your points
- the reasons or evidence for your arguments
- your brief but definite conclusion. In your conclusion list some of your main points—you may add a personal opinion.

Don't forget to:

- plan your writing before you start
- write in correctly formed sentences and take particular care with paragraphing
- choose your words carefully and pay attention to your spelling and punctuation
- write neatly but don't waste time
- quickly check your story once you have finished. Your position must be clear to your reader.

Remember: the stance taken in a persuasive text is not wrong, as long as the writer has evidence to support his or her opinion. How the opinion is supported is as important as the opinion itself.

Start writing here.

Turn to page 101 and use the Marking checklist to check the student's writing. Also go to pages 123–124 where the sample pieces of writing (Intermediate and Advanced levels) can be used to see whether your child is writing at this level.

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Writing Sample Test 1

Structure

Audience

The audience is readily identified (families, pupils, teachers). Background information is provided to give context to the points raised. Brief statements are made, outlining the issue to be discussed.

Persuasive techniques

Arguments for the writer's reaction are in separate paragraphs. The points raised are obviously important to the writer in a personal way.

Evidence and examples are used to support the argument. Objectivity is maintained throughout the writing.

Text structure

The text contains a well-organised introduction, body and conclusion.

The writer refers regularly to words used in the topic.

Paragraphing

New paragraphs, with topic sentences, are used for new arguments and the summary.

Cohesion

The final paragraph refers to the topic and re-establishes how the writer feels. There is a forceful, personal concluding sentence.

Pupil-free school days

Schools are allowed to have several pupil-free days each year. These are usually tacked onto end-of-term school holidays. They are free time for teachers to prepare school work. Should teachers have these extra days at school without pupils? I don't think so!

Firstly, why should schools be closed and teachers get extra holidays to prepare their work? You don't see police stations closed down so that police officers can prepare for future crimes. Nowhere else allows a place to shut down for a day so that workers can prepare for their work.

Surely teachers get enough holidays each year. There are at least ten weeks of holidays for teachers. Ten weeks is more than most other people get. If teachers have to prepare work all together, why can't they do it on a day when the pupils are on holidays?

Pupil-free days are wasted days for students wanting to complete their education. Pupils have to hang around waiting for school to begin. Many students are already bored with holidays. They haven't gone away because their parents still have to work.

Pupil-free days can cost parents money. Parents with young children have to get a babysitter. Many families have both parents working. One parent will take a holiday for the two weeks of school holidays but that leaves the extra day at the end. Special arrangements and payments have to be made.

Schools should not be given pupil-free days. Teachers with long holidays can do their planning during the holidays. They have enough holidays! Pupil-free days cause unwanted extra work and cost for the students' families, and are boring for the students. The school days should be used to everyone's advantage, especially the students.

Language and Ideas

Vocabulary

A good variety of precise verb types are used to establish strong, informed arguments.

Nouns are used to make generalised statements.

Adverbs and adjectives are well selected to qualify statements.

The pronoun *I* is used sparingly.

Sentence structure

There is a good variety of sentence beginnings (e.g. *Nowhere*, *Firstly*), types and lengths.

A topic sentence is used to introduce each paragraph's main idea.

Questions and exclamations are used to good effect.

Ideas

Ideas are well balanced to create a sense of rational, logical argument.

A strong viewpoint is expressed with a careful choice of words.

Ideas are presented forcefully.

Punctuation

Punctuation, including apostrophes and full stops, is correctly applied.

Spelling

There are no spelling mistakes of common or unusual words.

Please note that a Basic level of sample writing has not been provided. Such a sample would not be as well written as this Intermediate sample. This sample has not been written under test conditions. However, it gives you a standard to aim for.

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Writing Sample Test 1

Structure

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The audience is readily identified (families, pupils, teachers). Background information is provided to give context to the points raised. Brief statements are made, outlining the issue to be discussed.

Persuasive techniques

Arguments for the writer's reaction are in separate paragraphs. The points raised are obviously important to the writer in a personal way.

Evidence and examples are used to support the argument. Objectivity is maintained throughout the writing.

Text structure

The text contains a well-organised introduction, body and conclusion.

The writer refers regularly to words used in the topic.

Paragraphing

New paragraphs, with topic sentences, are used for new arguments and the summary.

Cohesion

The final paragraph refers to the topic and re-establishes how the writer feels. There is a forceful, personal concluding sentence.

Pupil-free school days

Schools are permitted to have several pupil-free days each year. These are usually tacked onto end-of-term school holidays. They are free time for teachers to prepare school work. Should teachers have these extra days at school without pupils? I don't think so!

Firstly, why should schools be closed and teachers get extra holidays to prepare their work? You don't see police stations closed down so that police officers can prepare for future crimes. Nowhere else allows a whole building to shut down for a day so that workers can prepare for their work.

Surely teachers get enough holidays each year. There are at least ten weeks of holidays for teachers. Ten weeks is more than most other workers get. If teachers have to prepare work all together, why can't they do it on a day when the pupils are on holidays?

Pupil-free days are wasted days for students wanting to complete their education. Pupils have to hang around waiting for school to begin. Many students are already bored with holidays. They haven't gone away because their parents still have to work. Some students hang around and get involved in anti-social behaviour. Pupils should be in school, not roaming the streets like feral animals.

Pupil-free days can be costly. Parents with young children have to get a babysitter. Many families have both parents working. One parent will take a holiday for the two weeks of school holidays but that usually leaves the extra day at the end. Special arrangements and payments have to be made.

Schools should not be given pupil-free days. Teachers with long holidays can do their planning during the holidays. They have enough holidays! Pupil-free days cause unwanted extra work, cost and inconvenience for the students' families, and are boring for the students. The school days should be used to everyone's advantage, especially the students.

Language and Ideas

Vocabulary

A good variety of precise verb types are used to establish strong, informed arguments.

Nouns are used to make generalised statements.

Adverbs and adjectives are well selected to qualify statements.

Sentence structure

There is a good variety of sentence beginnings (e.g. *Nowhere*, *Firstly*), types and lengths.

A topic sentence is used to introduce each paragraph's main idea.

Questions and exclamations are used to good effect.

Ideas

Ideas are well balanced to create a sense of rational, logical argument. A strong simile adds impact.

A strong viewpoint is expressed with careful choice of words.

Ideas are delivered forcefully.

Punctuation

Punctuation, including apostrophes and full stops, is correctly applied.

Spelling

There are no spelling mistakes of common or unusual words.

Please note that this sample has not been written under test conditions. During a test you might not have the time to produce such a polished piece of writing. However, this sample gives you a standard to aim for.